

Building a Django App

Django is an open source Web application framework that is built on the Model-View-Controller (MVC) architecture. It is a high level Python framework which enables the rapid development of Web apps. The author introduces readers to its basics along with a tutorial on creating a Web app.

A Web framework provides infrastructure to create Web applications without repetition of code. It contains apps to perform most of the common tasks that are required by the Web applications. Before getting your hands dirty on Django, you need to know something about Python. It is an open source general-purpose high-level programming language. It can be used for Web development, games creation, data visualisation, software development and much more.

Python installation

Python needs to be installed on the system in order to work with Django, which requires Python 2.3 or newer versions.

On Windows

You can download Python from <https://www.python.org/downloads/>. Run the downloaded file and it can be installed like any other Windows software (see Figure 1).

Once Python is installed, you need to add its executable file to your system's path.

On Linux

Most of the open source UNIX clones such as Linux or the BSD come with Python installed as a part of their core system.

Testing

Open a terminal and type the following command:

```
python.
```

Now, it's time to get started with Django, which is a Web framework written in Python. Using the former, we can build high quality and robust Web applications with minimal effort. Django is also known as '...the Web framework for perfectionists with deadlines.'

Django installation

Download the Django code from www.djangoproject.com/download/ and once that's done, open a terminal, navigate to the folder where Django has been downloaded and locate the file named *setup.py*.

On a Linux system, type the following command:

```
sudo setup.py install
```

On Windows, type:

```
python setup.py install
```

